BRAND IDENTITY, VERSION 1.0 PROPOSAL

AAICBI is an ecosystem, not a course site.

A redesigned identity for Africa's AI Capacity Building Initiative, organized by Futybills Tech Community. Nested Ascent: one mark that carries the acronym, upward movement, layered institutions and the single node where talent meets opportunity.



1 · ANALYSIS

What the current logo says

The present mark is a rounded teal tile holding a mortarboard, with the descriptor "Learning Management System" beneath the name.



Element	What it signals	Decision
Mortarboard	School, graduation	Removed
"Learning Management System"	Course administration software	Removed; replaced by the ecosystem's full name
Rounded app tile	Generic app icon, no ownable shape	Removed from the logo; used only for app icons
Pale-green accent stroke	Low contrast, weak at small sizes	Removed
Teal as the lead colour	Brand heritage	Kept, as the supporting colour (brighter) beside midnight navy
The acronym AAICBI	The name people already know	Kept, now the dominant element

2 · THREE DIRECTIONS

Concepts explored

Three different ideas, not three variations. Scores are a design judgement from 1 (weak) to 5 (strong), made by the designer for this proposal; they are not user-tested.



A · Nested Ascent (selected)

Idea. The letter A built from geometry alone: a large chevron, a second chevron inside it, and one node. It reads as A and A (Africa, AI), as upward movement, and as layers (people, institutions, industry).

Risk. A chevron can look like a generic “up” arrow, which the second chevron and the node counter.

Sophistication	**5**
Distinctiveness	**4**
Scalability	**5**
Ecosystem relevance	**4**

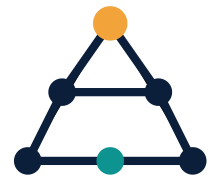


B · Open Aperture

Idea. Three arcs around an open centre, suggesting an iris, a lens, intelligence looking outward, with the node at the centre.

Risk. Close to many existing AI and camera marks; says nothing about Africa or the acronym.

Sophistication	**4**
Distinctiveness	**2**
Scalability	**4**
Ecosystem relevance	**3**



C · Node Lattice

Idea. A triangle of connected nodes: people and organizations joined in a network, one amber node for opportunity.

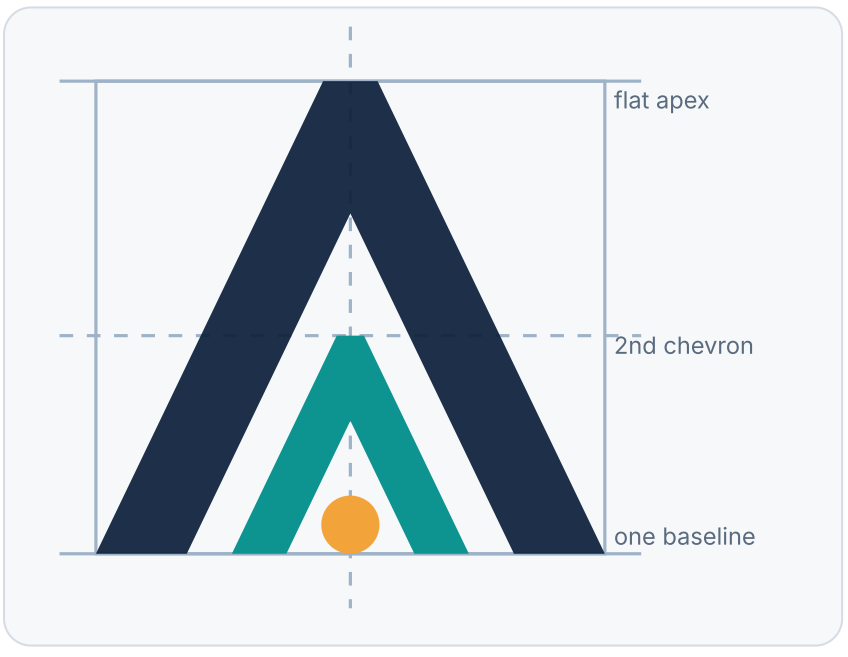
Risk. The “network of dots” is the most common technology cliché, and it breaks down below about 24 px.

Sophistication	**3**
Distinctiveness	**2**
Scalability	**2**
Ecosystem relevance	**5**

Why A. It is the only direction that holds up as a 16 px favicon, works as the letter in the name, and carries the ecosystem idea without an obvious technology icon.

3 · THE MARK

Nested Ascent



Large chevron (Midnight). The institution of the ecosystem: Africa’s AI community as a whole, rising. Its flat apex is a deliberate, print-safe cut rather than a needle point.

Second chevron (Signal Teal). The layer inside: trainees, professionals, startups and organizations, held by the larger structure and moving up with it. Its legs run parallel to the outer ones, at an even gap.

Node (Savanna Amber). The single point where talent meets an opportunity, an employer, an investor or a collaborator. It sits on the shared baseline and is the only warm colour in the identity.

African geometry, used quietly. The triangle and the layered, repeated chevron echo strip-woven and carved patterns found across the continent. They are abstracted, not copied from any single tradition.

4 · LOGO SYSTEM

Artwork

Every lockup comes in colour, reverse, black (mono) and white (mono). The artwork is plain geometry with outlined letters: no gradients, shadows or effects.

Primary logo (symbol, wordmark, full name), horizontal

For websites, documents, signage and any place there is room for the full name.



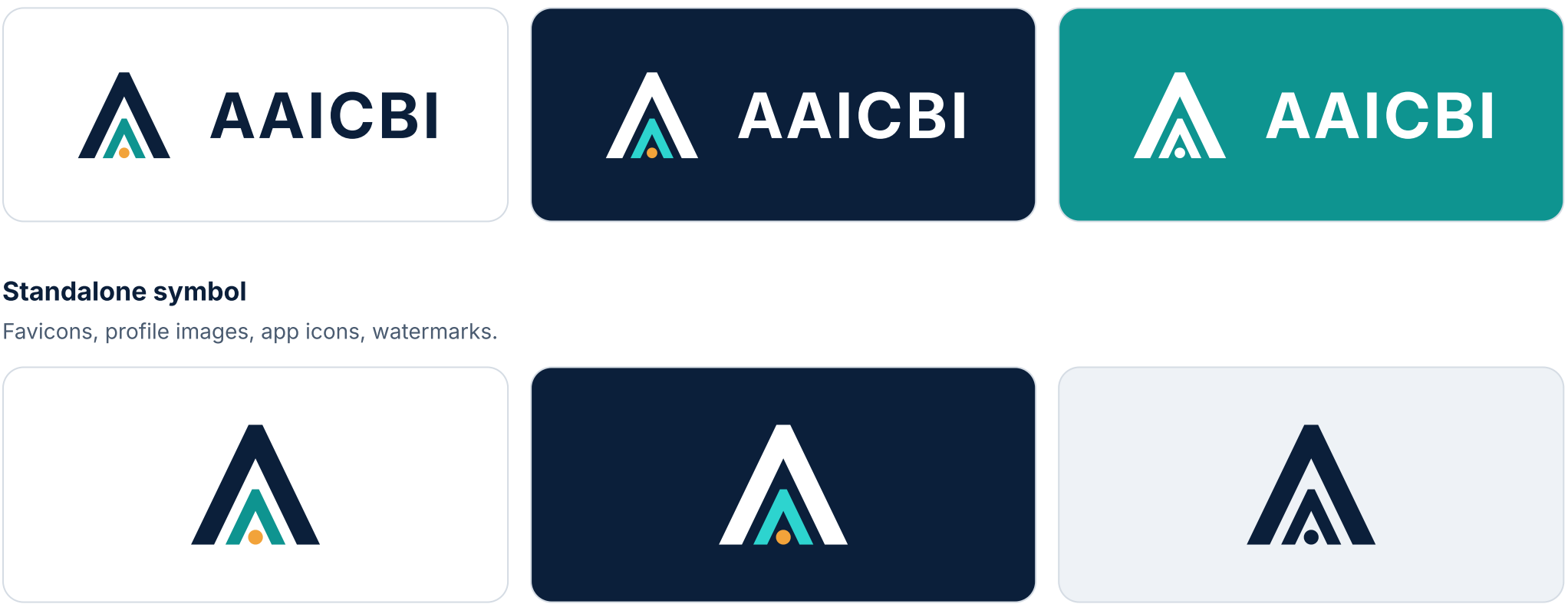
Primary logo, stacked

For covers, posters, conference backdrops and square or portrait spaces.



Secondary logo (symbol and wordmark)

For headers, app bars, email signatures and anywhere the full name would be too small to read.

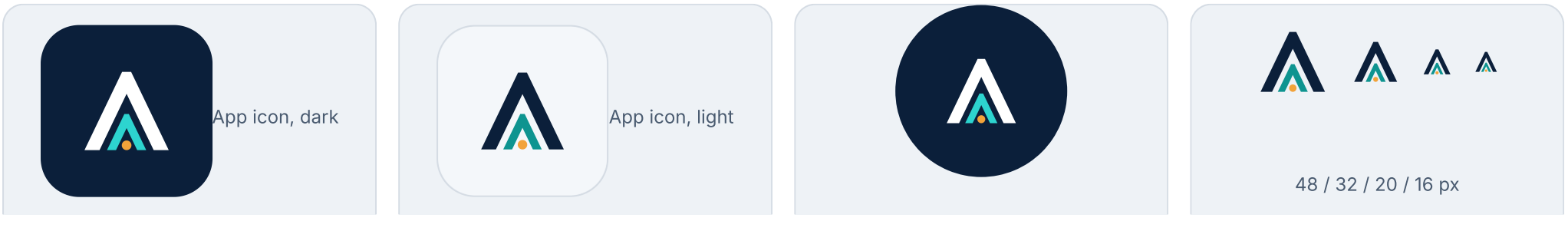


Standalone symbol

Favicons, profile images, app icons, watermarks.

App icons and small sizes

The rounded square exists only as an app-icon container; it is not part of the logo.



Maskable (cropped to a circle)

5 · COLOUR

Palette

Midnight leads. Teal supports. Amber appears once, as the node. Roughly 70% midnight and neutral, 25% teal, 5% amber.

#0B1F3A

Midnight

Primary. Wordmark, large fields, dark backgrounds

#0E9490

Signal Teal

Technology. Second chevron on light

#2DD4CF

Signal Teal Light

Second chevron on dark only

#F2A33A

Savanna Amber

The single accent: the node. Never text

#EEF2F6

Mist

Neutral backgrounds and panels

Contrast (WCAG 2.1 ratios, computed)

Pair	Ratio	Use
Midnight on white	16.5 : 1	Any text
Signal Teal on white	3.7 : 1	Graphics and large text only (not body text)
Signal Teal Light on Midnight	9.0 : 1	Any text on dark
Savanna Amber on Midnight	7.9 : 1	Any use on dark
Savanna Amber on white	2.1 : 1	The node only; never text, never a thin line

6 · TYPE

Typography

AAICBI

AFRICA’S AI CAPACITY BUILDING INITIATIVE

Wordmark. Inter Display Bold, converted to outlines, with +7% letter-spacing. It is neutral, geometric and legible at small sizes. I kept the standard letter A in the wordmark after testing a bar-less A: it was elegant but read as “MICBI” at small sizes.

Descriptor. Inter Display SemiBold capitals, +12% tracking, sized so the line is exactly as wide as the wordmark.

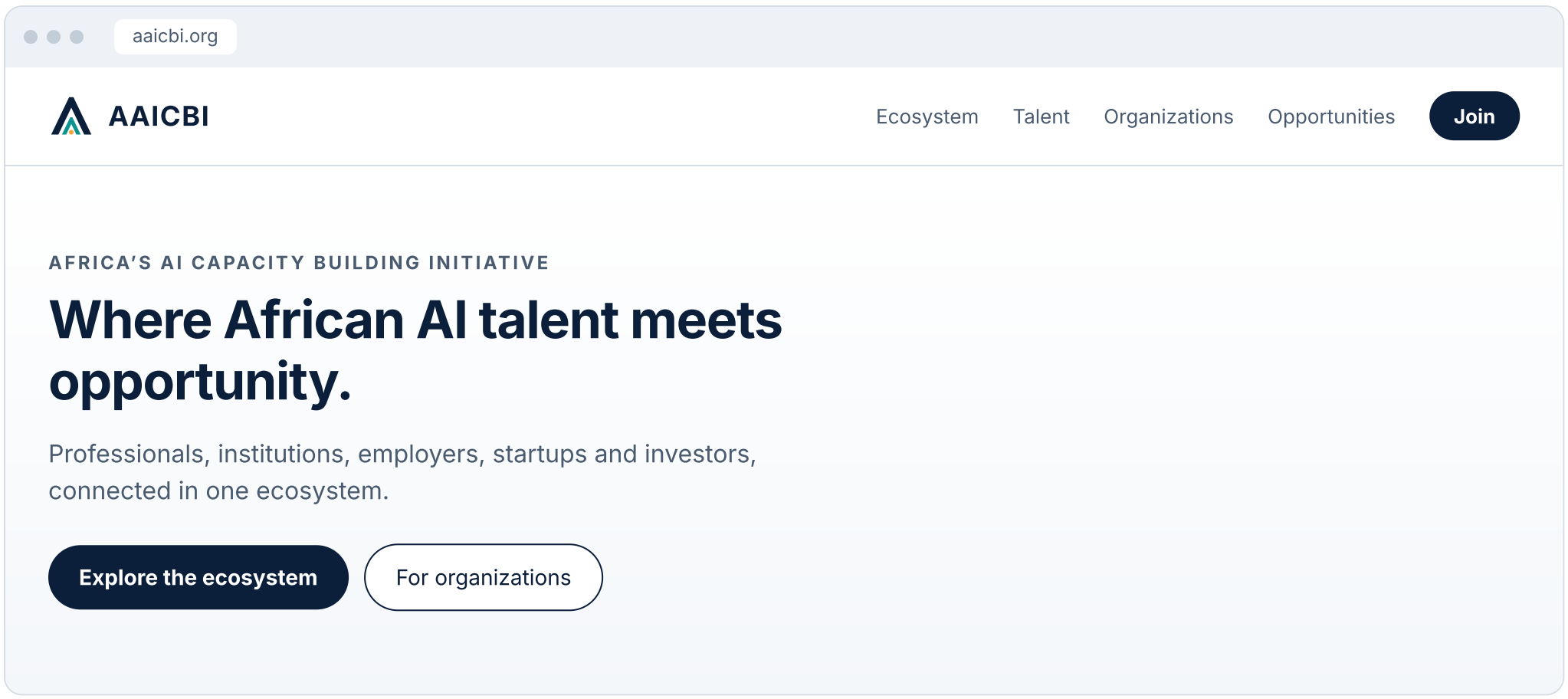
Recommended working fonts. Inter Display for headlines, Inter for text and interfaces (both free under the SIL Open Font License). The platform currently uses Manrope and Fraunces; moving to Inter would be a separate, optional change.

7 · IN USE

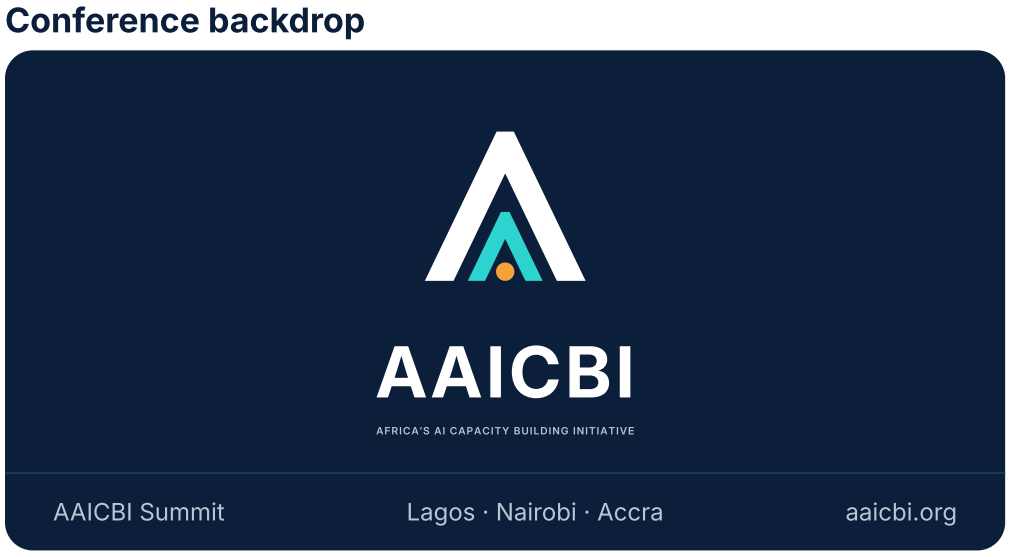
Applications

Understated, illustrative mockups drawn in HTML. They show scale and context; they are not production files.

Ecosystem website



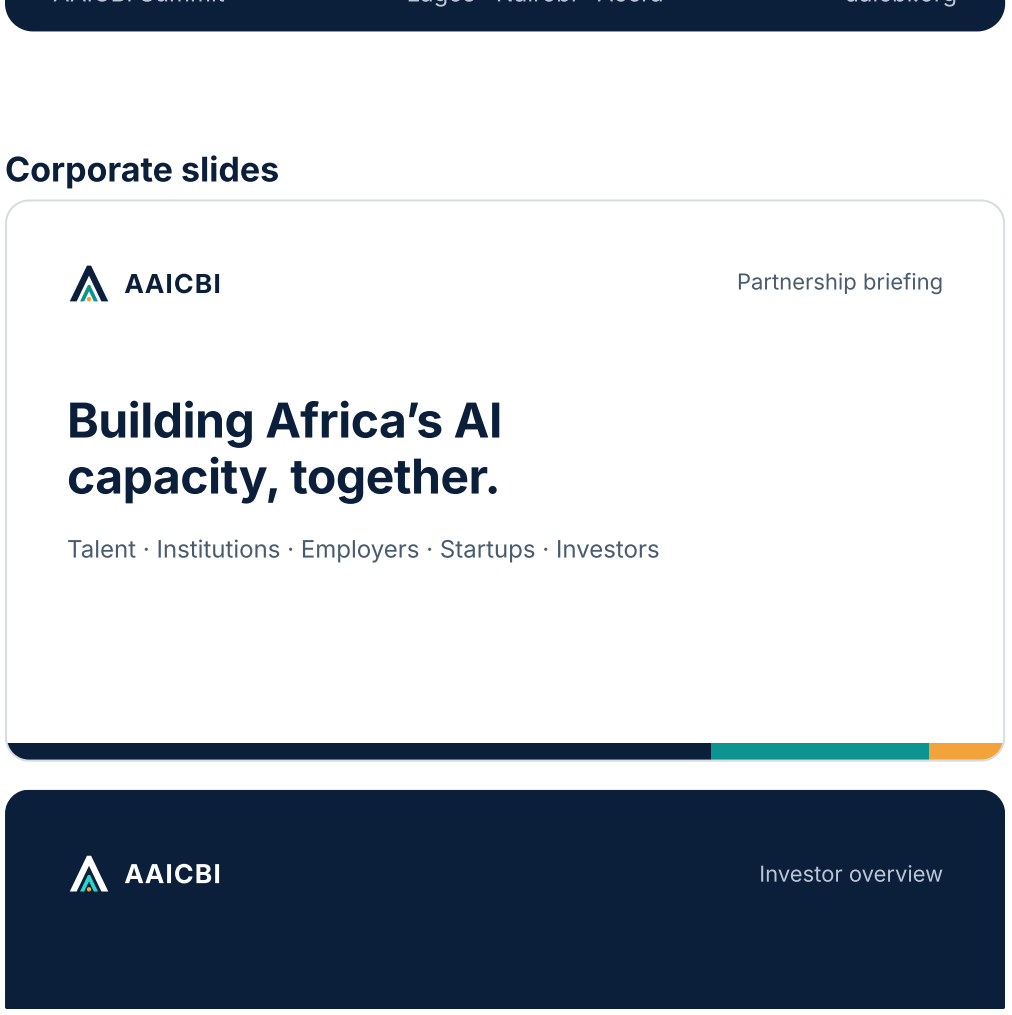
Conference backdrop



Investor and partnership slide



Corporate slides



Letterhead



One ecosystem. Four ways to take part.

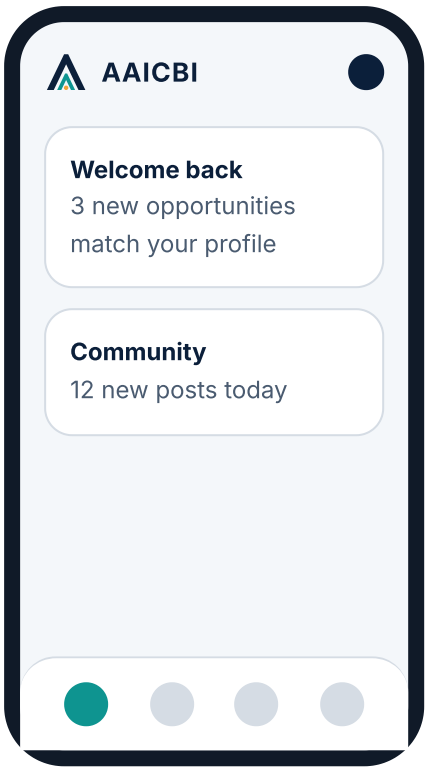
Train | Hire | Build | Invest

Organized by Futybills Tech Community aaicbi.org

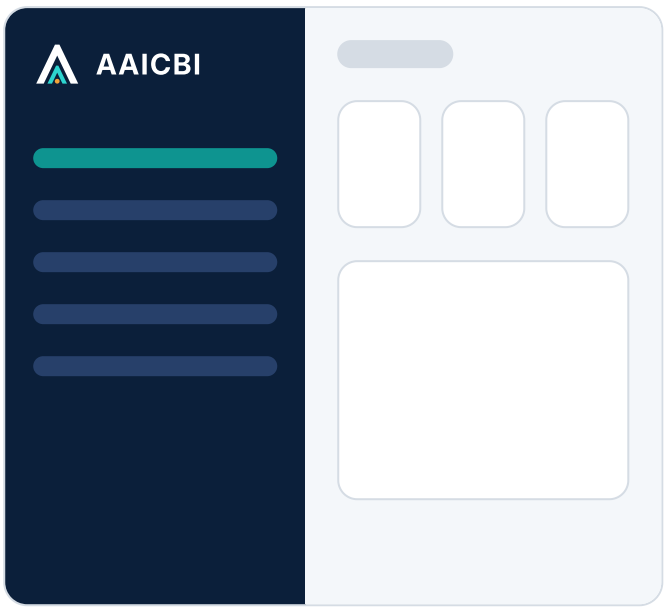
Social profile images



Mobile



Desktop



8 · USAGE

Brand usage guide

Clear space

Keep a margin of **x** on every side, where x is one quarter of the symbol's height. Nothing enters it.



Minimum size

Lockup	Digital	Print
Symbol	16 px high	5 mm high
Secondary logo	96 px wide	25 mm wide
Primary logo, horizontal	220 px wide	55 mm wide
Primary logo, stacked	130 px wide	35 mm wide

Below the primary sizes the full name becomes unreadable: switch to the secondary logo, then to the symbol.

Backgrounds

Colour logo on white, Mist or very light neutrals. Reverse on Midnight or any dark with at least 7 : 1 contrast. White (mono) on a single solid brand colour or a photo with a dark overlay. Black (mono, Midnight) for one-colour print, fax, stamps and embossing.

Incorrect usage



✕ Do not stretch or squash



✕ Do not rotate or tilt



✕ Do not change the colours



✕ Do not add shadows or glows



✕ Do not use low contrast



✕ Do not place on busy images



✕ Do not put the colour logo on mid-tone colour



✕ Do not rearrange, mirror or re-space the parts

9 · FILES

What is delivered

All files are in `docs/brand/`. The SVGs were generated by `build_logo.py` from the geometry and outlined letterforms; they are real vector files, but I have not opened them in a design application such as Illustrator, and the only PDF is this guide, not a print-ready master of the logo artwork.

File	Use
`svg/aaicbi-primary-{horizontal,stacked}[-reverse|-mono|-mono-white].svg`	Full logo with the organization's name
`svg/aaicbi-secondary-{horizontal,stacked}[-reverse|-mono|-mono-white].svg`	Symbol and wordmark
`svg/aaicbi-symbol[-reverse|-mono|-mono-white].svg`	Standalone symbol
`svg/aaicbi-app-icon{,-light,-maskable}.svg`	App icons
`png/*.png`	Raster exports, rendered from the SVGs
`brand-guide.html and brand-guide.pdf`	This guide
`build_logo.py, build_guide.py`	Regenerate everything

Not done yet: the platform itself still shows the former logo. Replacing it (header, emails, certificates, app icons, favicon) is a separate step.